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Suffolk University/*Boston Globe* Massachusetts Poll: Despite Voter Unhappiness with Economy and Taxes, Markey, Healey and Other Incumbents Hold Strong Leads

BOSTON—Two weeks before the midterm elections, incumbent US Senator Ed Markey and Governor Maura Healey—along with several top incumbent statewide officeholders—have decisive leads over their opponents, according to a Suffolk University/*Boston Globe* poll of likely Massachusetts general election voters.

In the Senate runoff, Markey, a Democrat, leads Republican John Deaton (60%-32%), with Joe Tache (Party for Socialism and Liberation) and independent Shiva Ayyadurai each receiving 1%, with 6% of voters undecided.

In the governor's race, Democrat Maura Healey (59%) leads Republican Mike Minogue (36%) and independent Andrea James (2%), with 3% of voters undecided.

But a sizable number of voters are dissatisfied with the Massachusetts economy and believe their quality of life has deteriorated over the past four years. Fifty-eight percent of Bay State voters rated the economy as fair or poor, and more than half (55%) say taxes are too high.

Despite this, those surveyed say they are even more unhappy with President Donald Trump, who garnered a 72% unfavorable rating. Sixty percent of voters indicated they had negative views of Republican candidates connected to or supportive of the president.

"Voters may agree with Mike Minogue that taxes are too high and that Massachusetts has become a worse to place to live over the past four years," said David Paleologos, director of the Suffolk University Political Research Center. "But that message is coming from someone who is perceived as too close to Donald Trump, one of the reasons Minogue hasn't gotten traction in his race against Governor Healey."

Incumbent Democrats also held wide leads in their statewide office races, with State Auditor Diana DiZoglio leading Libertarian Al Ozonoff (62%-15%), Secretary of State Bill Galvin over Republican Anne Brensley (67%-21%), State Treasurer Deborah Goldberg ahead of Elizabeth Dionne (58%-24%), and Attorney General Andrea Campbell over Michael Walsh (54%-28%).

In the midterm bellwether city of Quincy, which has been remarkably consistent at predicting statewide outcomes for US Senate and governor, Markey leads Deaton 58%-30% while Healey leads Minogue 56%-30%.

Voters also weighed in on the nine statewide ballot questions, with questions 1, 2, 4, and 9—to widen access to public records, allow employees in the state's public defender office to unionize, allow same-day voter registration, and keep stronger gun laws enacted by the state in 2024—showing sizable leads. Question 8, to repeal the state's 2016 marijuana legalization laws, is trending to be overwhelmingly rejected.

Questions 5 and 7—changing limits on state revenue collections and allowing homes to be built on smaller lots in some residential areas— are much closer and also show a relatively higher number of undecided voters, suggesting there is limited knowledge about the proposals or confusion about how the questions are worded. Question 3—a proposal to eliminate party primaries—is polling close, with 47% supporting the measure and 41% opposed and 10% undecided, within the margin of error.

Methodology

The Suffolk University statewide survey of 500 likely voters and the midterm bellwether of 300 Quincy voters were conducted October 14-18, and are based on live interviews of likely general election voters in Massachusetts. Each area's quota and demographic information—including party affiliation, gender, race, and age—were determined from similar midterm exit polls and 2024 census data. The 14 Massachusetts counties were grouped into four general regions. The margin of sampling error for results based on the total sample is +/- 4.4 percentage points. Suffolk University students Eliana Favro, John Hotaling, and Chabota Kapaale contributed questions to this survey. Marginals and full cross-tabulation data are posted on the Suffolk University Political Research Center website. For more information, contact David Paleologos at 781-290-9310, dpaleologos@suffolk.edu.

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